

The Significance Predicament of Education

When it comes to the significance of education, a trite topic which has been discussed throughout the past to present, from literati and officialdom to farmers and workers, I am afraid that hardly can anyone squeeze out anything refreshing or worthy from it, only could reiterate the views of predecessors. Such a topic, why we still talk about, and what else can we offer to? What's more, does the massive amount of discussions on this topic necessarily demonstrate that we are profoundly aware and accepting the significance of education?

Unfortunately, the reverse situation probably is true that we are just in the significance predicament of education.

For one thing, although the significance of education seems to be endowed with undisputed and self-evident status, it is not internalized by overall people in effect. The paradox as it is that on the one hand, higher education is bundled with decent employment and privileged life, while on the other hand the clamour of "useless education" peals out. For some families, especially the impoverished ones, workplaces are outstripping schools, on account that the former brings forth foreseeable and practical earnings, while the latter is more risky and erratic with possible repercussion of unsatisfied ration of input-output and even unemployment, for which there is multiple corroborative evidence that some uneducated youngsters lived an affluent life through their years of hard work, while those graduate students were idling about. What's worse, not only the poor are skeptical of education but also some of the intelligent subscribe to anti-intellectualism. A representative case in point is Han Han, the so-called "uneducated literary genius". Han, who flunked out of school because of failing 7 subjects in two consecutive years, shot to fame in 1999 for only spending an hour inditing a broadly lauded composition with copious allusions and sophisticated language, and thus dropped a subversive bomb to China education. Thenceforth, he also violently satirized literary and historical knowledge, humiliated teachers and scholars, and derogated the significance of education in his officially published works. His comments have attracted legions of fans and supporters, even including university professors and public figures. Until now, anti-intellectualism still lurks in social media and news reports. Concerning the significance of education, no matter for the poor or the intellectual, it is still a question whether to be or not to be.

For another, most people may have faith in the significance of education, but what they comprehend might not be the authentic significance of education, but the alienated one. From most perspectives of students and parents, the significance of education is exaggerated to the meaning of the whole life. It is the linear logic they comply with that what education one accepts directly correlates with, or even determine what life one will live in the future. In other words, the reason why education is significant is that it is the only channel to ascent and consolidate class. In such circumstances, where the significance of one's existence and living is given by the outside world, instead of emanating from one's own heart, it is easy for them to collapse, and that may be the reason why a mounting number of students is afflicted

by psychological illnesses, particularly depression. Provided that one fails to take the lead or to keep abreast with peers in the study, he would regard himself in forlorn hope to succeed in life. Otherwise, if one achieves a milestone, such as success in the entrance exam of college, he might also be perplexed about his life for being unsure what to pursue next. This not only distorts the meaning of life, but also the significance of education. They lay emphasis on education principally for its utilitarian function in seeking desired jobs and gaining more opportunities, thus to leap in class, but the foremost significance of education to nourish one's morality and soul is neglected. No one cares about souls, and therefore the spiritual significance of education is of no significance.

It is the best of times; it is the worst of times. It is the age of wisdom; it is the age of foolishness. It is the epoch of belief; it is the epoch of incredulity. It is the spring of education, for it prevails above all; it is the winter of education, for it can bring nothing at all.

Who am I?

A student.

Where did I come from?

Poverty and ignorance.

Where am I going?

Money and power.

Thanks to education for changing my fate.